Lecture 12: Proof of Lemma 3.14 and Tightness

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Welcome to Lecture 12. Please settle down. Today, we are going to dive directly into the rigorous proof of Lemma 3.14, which is the absolute theoretical cornerstone of the weak (martingale) solution framework we established in our last session.

If you recall, we dropped the Minty–Browder monotonicity trick in favor of a powerful topological approach, relying on the compact embedding of our spaces. Let us walk through the first page of today's notes meticulously to see exactly how we establish the tightness of our probability measures.

1. The Setup and the A Priori Estimate

At the very top of the page, I restate our core SPDE:

$$du(t) = A(u(t))\,dt + B(u(t))\,dW(t).$$

We are working with our finite-dimensional Galerkin approximation, denoted here as u_N, which lives in the span of our first N basis vectors,

$$V_N = \operatorname{span}\{e_1, \dots, e_N\}.$$

Notice that I explicitly reiterate our new, fundamental assumption: the highly regular space V is compactly embedded into the central Hilbert space H,

$$V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H.$$

Just below this, I write the most important bound in all of SPDE theory, namely our a priori estimate. Because of the coercivity of our operators, we established earlier that the supremum over all approximation dimensions $N \geq 1$ of the expectation of the system's energy is finite. Specifically,

$$\sup_{N\geq 1} \mathbb{E}\Big(\sup_{t\leq T} \|u_N(t)\|_H^2 + \int_0^T \|u_N(t)\|_V^2\,dt\Big) < \infty.$$

Because we are transitioning to the martingale problem, we can rewrite this expectation entirely in terms of the probability laws of our approximations, denoted by P_N, or equivalently by $\mathbb{E}_N$ for the expectation under this law. The bound remains identical:

$$\sup_{N\geq 1} \mathbb{E}_{P_N}\Big(\sup_{t\leq T} \|u(t)\|_H^2 + \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2\,dt\Big) < \infty.$$

This uniform bound is the raw material we will use to build our compact sets.

2. Restating Lemma 3.14 and Tightness

We now formally begin the proof of Lemma 3.14. The lemma asserts that the sequence of probability measures (P_n) is tight on the massive intersection space

$$\Omega := C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}}) \cap L^2([0,T]; V) \cap L^2([0,T]; H).$$

To prove tightness on this complex space, we must prove it with respect to three distinct topologies, which I list explicitly:

- τ_1 is the weak topology on $L^2([0,T]; V)$;
- τ_2 is the uniform topology on $C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}})$;
- τ_3 is the strong topology on $L^2([0,T]; H)$.

Lemma 1 (Lemma 3.14)**.** The sequence of probability measures (P_n) is tight on

$$\Omega := C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}}) \cap L^2([0,T]; V) \cap L^2([0,T]; H)$$

with respect to the three topologies

$$\tau_1, \tau_2, \tau_3,$$

where τ_1 is the weak topology on $L^2([0,T]; V)$, τ_2 is the uniform topology on $C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}})$, and τ_3 is the strong topology on $L^2([0,T]; H)$.

Before we attack τ_1, let us define what tightness actually means in measure theory. A sequence of measures (μ_n) is tight on a space E if and only if for every arbitrarily small $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a compact subset $K_\varepsilon \subseteq E$ such that

$$\mu_n(K_\varepsilon^c) \leq \varepsilon \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

Thus the measure of the complement, namely the probability of escaping the compact set, is bounded by ε.

3. Proof of τ_1-Tightness

Let us now execute step 1 of the proof, namely establishing tightness with respect to the weak topology τ_1.

Proof of τ_1-tightness. To do this, we must construct a specific set that is compact in τ_1, and then prove that our process is overwhelmingly likely to stay inside it. Look at the set

$$K_1 := \Big\{ u \in L^2([0,T]; V) \;\Big|\; \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt \leq K \Big\}.$$

This set consists of all processes whose integrated V-norm squared is bounded by a strict constant K.

Why is this set compact in our topology τ_1? Because $L^2([0,T]; V)$ is a reflexive Banach space, in fact a Hilbert space, and therefore every closed and bounded ball is weakly compact. This is the standard functional-analytic input, often cited through Banach–Alaoglu in this context. Therefore, K_1 is a perfectly valid compact set for the weak topology τ_1.

Now we must measure the probability that our approximate process u escapes this compact set under the law P_n. We want to evaluate

$$P_n(K_1^c) = P_n\Big(\int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt > K\Big).$$

To bound this, we use one of the most fundamental tools in probability, namely Markov's inequality. Recall that if $X \geq 0$ is a nonnegative random variable and $K > 0$, then

$$\mathbb{P}(X > K) \leq \frac{\mathbb{E}[X]}{K}.$$

Here we apply this with

$$X = \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt.$$

This random variable is nonnegative, so Markov's inequality gives

$$P_n(K_1^c) \leq \frac{1}{K} \, \mathbb{E}_{P_n}\Big(\int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt\Big).$$

This is where the grand design comes together. The expectation on the right-hand side is exactly the quantity controlled by our a priori estimate at the top of the page. Therefore there exists a constant $C < \infty$ such that

$$P_n(K_1^c) \leq \frac{C}{K} \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

As indicated by the arrow $K \to \infty$, if we are given any $\varepsilon > 0$, we simply choose

$$K \geq \frac{C}{\varepsilon},$$

then

$$P_n(K_1^c) \leq \varepsilon \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

Because this holds uniformly for all n, we have rigorously proved that the sequence of measures is tight with respect to the weak topology τ_1. □

4. What Remains

At the very bottom of the page, one sees the heading for our next hurdle: "2) τ_2 - tightness". Proving tightness in the uniform topology of the dual space will require a much more delicate argument involving time regularity and compactness in the dual space.

The proof of Lemma 3.14 is therefore not finished yet. After τ_1-tightness, the next tasks are the tightness with respect to τ_2 and τ_3. The latter is precisely where the compact embedding

$$V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H$$

plays its decisive role.

5. Proof of τ_2-Tightness

Excellent. Let us turn the page and continue. Having successfully secured tightness in the weak topology τ_1, we now face a much more delicate challenge: proving τ_2-tightness.

Recall that τ_2 is the uniform topology on the space of continuous functions taking values in the weak topology of our dual space,

$$C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}}).$$

To prove tightness here, we must show that our approximate processes do not oscillate wildly or develop discontinuities in V'.

5.1. The Compact Set K_2 and Arzelà–Ascoli

At the top of the page, one defines the candidate compact set

$$K_2 = \left\{ u \in C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}}) : \sup_{t\in[0,T]} \|u(t)\|_H \le k, \sup_{0\le s<t\le T} \frac{\|u(t)-u(s)\|_{V'}}{|t-s|^\beta} \le k \right\}.$$

Thus a process u, viewed as a continuous path in $C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}})$, belongs to K_2 if it satisfies two conditions simultaneously, both controlled by the threshold $k > 0$:

- uniform boundedness in H,
$$\sup_{t\in[0,T]} \|u(t)\|_H \le k;$$
- equicontinuity through a Hölder bound in V',
$$\sup_{0\le s<t\le T} \frac{\|u(t)-u(s)\|_{V'}}{|t-s|^\beta} \le k \qquad \text{for some } \beta > 0.$$

Why does this specific set work? By the formal Arzelà–Ascoli theorem stated in the appendix, it is enough to verify pointwise relative compactness and equicontinuity. In the present setting, the pointwise relative compactness comes from the H-bound together with Banach–Alaoglu, while the Hölder estimate gives the equicontinuity needed for the τ_2-tightness argument.

Our goal, exactly as before, is to prove that

$$P_n(K_2^c) \to 0 \qquad \text{uniformly in } n \text{ as } k \to \infty.$$

5.2. Decomposing the Increment in V'

To control the Hölder norm, we analyze the increment $u(t) - u(s)$ in the dual space V'. The standard way to measure the V'-norm is to test against an arbitrary vector $h \in V$ with

$$\|h\|_V \le 1.$$

Recall that the SPDE can be written in integral form as

$$u(t) = u(s) + \int_s^t A(u(r))\, dr + \int_s^t B_n(u(r))\, dW_n(r).$$

Using the SPDE, we write

$${}_{V'}\langle u(t) - u(s), h\rangle_V = \int_s^t {}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)), h\rangle_V\, dr + \int_s^t \langle h, B_n(u(r))\, dW_n(r)\rangle.$$

We then apply the triangle inequality and split the problem into two parts:

$$
\begin{aligned}
|{}_{V'}\langle u(t)-u(s),h\rangle_V| &\le \left|\int_s^t {}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V\,dr\right| + \left|\int_s^t \langle h, B_n(u(r))\,dW_n(r)\rangle\right| \\
&\le \int_s^t |{}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V|\,dr + \left|\int_s^t \langle h, B_n(u(r))\,dW_n(r)\rangle\right|.
\end{aligned}
$$

- the deterministic drift integral;
- the stochastic diffusion integral.

This decomposition is the guiding principle of the entire argument.

5.3. Bounding the Deterministic Drift

We first estimate

$$\int_s^t |{}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V|\,dr.$$

By the linear growth condition (V.3),

$$\|A(u)\|_{V'} \le M(1+\|u\|_V),$$

and therefore

$$|{}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V| \le \|A(u(r))\|_{V'}\,\|h\|_V \le M(1+\|u(r)\|_V),$$

where the factor $\|h\|_V \le 1$ has been absorbed into the constant M. After integration over $[s,t]$, we obtain

$$\int_s^t |{}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V|\,dr \le M\int_s^t (1+\|u(r)\|_V)\,dr.$$

Applying Cauchy–Schwarz in time to the second term gives the estimate recalled in Appendix A.6:

$$\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V\,dr \le |t-s|^{1/2}\Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{1/2}.$$

Since we are considering $0 \le s < t \le T$, one has $|t-s| = t-s$; we keep the notation $|t-s|$ because Hölder continuity is conventionally written in terms of the distance between the two time points. Hence

$$\int_s^t |{}_{V'}\langle A(u(r)),h\rangle_V|\,dr \le M\Big(|t-s| + |t-s|^{1/2}\Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{1/2}\Big).$$

Thus the drift component exhibits 1/2-Hölder continuity, driven by the same a priori energy term as before.

5.4. Bounding the Stochastic Diffusion via BDG

We now turn to the stochastic integral

$$\int_s^t \langle h, B_n(u(r))\,dW_n(r)\rangle.$$

The quantity to control is

$$\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{r\in[s,t]}\Big|\int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u)\,dW_n\rangle\Big|^p\Big).$$

Here one invokes the Burkholder–Davis–Gundy inequality recalled in Appendix A.7, which yields

$$\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{r\in[s,t]}\Big|\int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u)\,dW_n\rangle\Big|^p\Big) \le C_p\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big[\Big(\int_s^t \|B(u(r))\circ\sqrt{Q}\|^2_{L_2(U,H)}\,dr\Big)^{p/2}\Big].$$

Using the sub-linear growth assumption (V.5),

$$\|B(u)\circ\sqrt{Q}\|_{L_2(U,H)} \le M(1+\|u\|_V^{1-\delta}),$$

we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
\Big(\int_s^t \|B(u(r))\circ\sqrt{Q}\|^2_{L_2(U,H)}\,dr\Big)^{p/2} &\le M\Big(\int_s^t (1+\|u(r)\|_V^{1-\delta})^2\,dr\Big)^{p/2} && \text{(by (V.5))}\\
&\le M\Big(\int_s^t 2\big(1+\|u(r)\|_V^{2(1-\delta)}\big)\,dr\Big)^{p/2} && \text{(since } (1+a)^2\le 2(1+a^2))\\
&\le M\Big(|t-s|+\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^{2(1-\delta)}\,dr\Big)^{p/2} && \text{(since } \int_s^t 1\,dr = |t-s|\text{, absorbing cons}
\end{aligned}$$

Since $1-\delta\le 1$, Hölder's inequality yields

$$\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^{2(1-\delta)}\,dr \le |t-s|^\delta\Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{1-\delta}.$$

Therefore,

$$\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{r\in[s,t]}\Big|\int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u)\,dW_n\rangle\Big|^p\Big) \le M\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big[\Big(|t-s|+|t-s|^\delta\Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{1-\delta}\Big)^{p/2}\Big].$$

Using $(a+b)^{p/2}\le C_p(a^{p/2}+b^{p/2})$, we further obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{r\in[s,t]}\Big|\int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u)\,dW_n\rangle\Big|^p\Big) &\le M\Big(|t-s|^{p/2}+|t-s|^{\delta p/2}\mathbb{E}_n\Big[\Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{(1-\delta)p/2}\Big]\Big)\\
&\le M\Big(|t-s|^{p/2}+|t-s|^{\delta p/2}\mathbb{E}_n\Big[\Big(\int_0^T \|u(r)\|_V^2\,dr\Big)^{(1-\delta)p/2}\Big]\Big).
\end{aligned}$$

Hence, provided the corresponding moment of the energy is finite, we arrive at

$$\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{r\in[s,t]}\Big|\int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u)\,dW_n\rangle\Big|^p\Big) \le C\,|t-s|^{\delta p/2}.$$

If $p>2/\delta$, then $\delta p/2>1$, and Kolmogorov's continuity theorem yields a modification with Hölder exponent

$$\alpha < \frac{\delta p/2-1}{p} = \frac{\delta}{2}-\frac{1}{p}.$$

More precisely, the scalar-valued process

$$X_h(t) := \int_0^t \langle h, B_n(u(r))\,dW_n(r)\rangle$$

admits a modification whose sample paths are Hölder continuous of every order

$$\alpha < \frac{\delta}{2}-\frac{1}{p}.$$

Thus, after testing against $h\in V$, the stochastic term yields the required time equicontinuity. In the Brownian case, the optimal regularity threshold is $1/2$, so one expects Hölder exponents strictly smaller than $1/2$.

5.5. Final Conclusion via Markov's Inequality

We now combine the drift and diffusion estimates. Exactly as in the proof of τ_1-tightness, we use Markov's inequality.

The probability that the process violates either the H-bound or the Hölder equicontinuity bound, that is, the probability of escaping K_2, is controlled by Let

$$[u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} := \sup_{0\le s<t\le T} \frac{\|u(t)-u(s)\|_{V'}}{|t-s|^\beta}.$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} P_n(K_2^c) &= P_n\Big(\sup_{0\le t\le T}\|u(t)\|_H > k \text{ or } [u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} > k\Big) \\ &\le P_n\Big(\sup_{0\le t\le T}\|u(t)\|_H > k\Big) + P_n\Big([u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} > k\Big) \\ &\le \frac{1}{k^2}\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{0\le t\le T}\|u(t)\|_H^2\Big) + \frac{1}{k}\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big([u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')}\Big). \end{aligned}$$

Since $k \ge 1$, this implies

$$P_n(K_2^c) \le \frac{1}{k}\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{0\le t\le T}\|u(t)\|_H^2 + [u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')}\Big).$$

By the drift estimate from Appendix A.6a and the stochastic estimate from Section 5.4, we obtain

$$\sup_n P_n(K_2^c) \le \frac{C}{k}\,\mathbb{E}_n\Big(\sup_{0\le t\le T}\|u(t)\|_H^2 + \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2\,dt\Big).$$

The expectation on the right-hand side is uniformly bounded by our global a priori estimate. Absorbing this bound into the constant C, we obtain

$$\sup_n P_n(K_2^c) \le \frac{C}{k}.$$

Therefore, as $k \to \infty$, the probability of escaping the compact set K_2 goes to zero uniformly in n.

We have thus proved τ_2-tightness.

6. Proof of τ_3-Tightness via Aubin–Lions

Welcome to the final, spectacular culmination of Lemma 3.14. We have already conquered tightness in the weak topology τ_1 and the dual uniform topology τ_2. Now we face the ultimate test: proving τ_3-tightness, which demands strong compactness in the central space

$$L^2([0,T];H).$$

To achieve this, we synthesize everything we have built so far by invoking the Aubin–Lions lemma.

6.1. The Statement of Aubin–Lions (Lemma 3.15)

Look at the precise statement of Lemma 3.15. We are given a sequence $(u_n)_n$ satisfying two core properties:

- it is bounded in $L^2([0,T];V) \cap L^\infty([0,T];H)$;
- it is equicontinuous as a V'-valued function, with initial condition

$$u_n(0) \to u_0 \qquad \text{in } H.$$

These are exactly the properties secured on the previous pages using the a priori estimates and the Arzelà–Ascoli theorem.

Lemma 2 (Aubin–Lions, Lemma 3.15)**.** Let $(u_n)_n$ be a sequence of functions

$$u_n : [0,T] \to V'$$

such that

$$(u_n)_n \text{ is bounded in } L^2([0,T];V) \cap L^\infty([0,T];H),$$

and suppose that $(u_n)_n$ is equicontinuous as V'-valued functions, with initial conditions satisfying

$$u_n(0) \to u_0 \qquad \text{in } H.$$

Then $(u_n)_n$ is relatively compact in $L^2([0,T];H)$. In particular, there exists a subsequence $(u_{n_k})_k$ and a limit u such that

$$u_{n_k} \to u \qquad \text{strongly in } L^2([0,T];H).$$

Intuitively, this lemma says that if a sequence is uniformly bounded in $L^2([0,T];V)$ and $L^\infty([0,T];H)$, and its trajectories do not oscillate too much in the weaker space V', then the family is precompact in the intermediate space $L^2([0,T];H)$.

This lemma provides the exact bridge we need for τ_3-tightness. The entire proof hinges on a brilliant interpolation inequality.

6.2. The Engine: The Interpolation Fact

This is the mathematical engine behind the Aubin–Lions lemma. Because we assumed that

$$V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H,$$

the following estimate holds.

Lemma 3 (Interpolation fact)**.** Then for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists a constant $C_\varepsilon > 0$ such that

$$\|u\|_H \le \varepsilon \|u\|_V + C_\varepsilon \|u\|_{V'} \qquad \text{for all } u \in V.$$

This estimate says that one can control the intermediate H-norm of a function using an arbitrarily small multiple of its strong V-norm, provided one compensates with a large multiple of its weak V'-norm.

6.3. Proof of the Interpolation Fact

Proof. Suppose, for contradiction, that the statement is false. Then there exists some $\varepsilon_0 > 0$ such that for every $n \geq 1$ one can find $u_n \in V$ with

$$\|u_n\|_H \geq \varepsilon_0 \|u_n\|_V + n\|u_n\|_{V'} \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

To analyze this pathological sequence, we normalize it and define

$$\widetilde{u}_n := \frac{u_n}{\|u_n\|_H}.$$

Then

$$1 = \|\widetilde{u}_n\|_H \qquad \text{for all } n,$$

and dividing the previous inequality by $\|u_n\|_H$ gives

$$1 = \|\widetilde{u}_n\|_H \geq \varepsilon_0 \|\widetilde{u}_n\|_V + n\|\widetilde{u}_n\|_{V'}.$$

Hence

$$\|\widetilde{u}_n\|_V \leq \frac{1}{\varepsilon_0}, \qquad \|\widetilde{u}_n\|_{V'} \leq \frac{1}{n}.$$

Thus $(\widetilde{u}_n)_n$ is bounded in V. Since V is reflexive, Banach–Alaoglu implies that bounded sets are weakly relatively compact, so there exists a subsequence $(\widetilde{u}_{n_k})_k$ and some $\widetilde{u} \in V$ such that

$$\widetilde{u}_{n_k} \rightharpoonup \widetilde{u} \qquad \text{weakly in } V.$$

Because the embedding $V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H$ is compact, this bounded subsequence admits a further subsequence $(\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}})_\ell$ such that

$$\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}} \to \widetilde{u} \qquad \text{strongly in } H.$$

At the same time, since

$$\|\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}}\|_{V'} \leq \frac{1}{n_{k_\ell}},$$

and $n_{k_\ell} \to \infty$ as $\ell \to \infty$, we obtain

$$\|\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}}\|_{V'} \to 0.$$

Hence

$$\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}} \to 0 \qquad \text{strongly in } V'.$$

On the other hand, since

$$\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}} \to \widetilde{u} \qquad \text{strongly in } H,$$

and the embedding $H \hookrightarrow V'$ is continuous, it follows that

$$\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}} \to \widetilde{u} \qquad \text{strongly in } V'.$$

By uniqueness of the limit in V', we must therefore have

$$\widetilde{u} = 0 \qquad \text{in } V'.$$

Hence the strong limit in H must be zero. But this is impossible, because

$$\|\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}}\|_H = 1 \qquad \text{for all } \ell,$$

and strong convergence in H implies

$$\|\widetilde{u}\|_H = \lim_{\ell \to \infty} \|\widetilde{u}_{n_{k_\ell}}\|_H = 1.$$

Thus the limit would have to be simultaneously 0 and norm 1, a contradiction. The interpolation fact is proved. $\square$

6.4. Executing the Proof of Aubin–Lions

Proof. Because the sequence is pointwise relatively compact in V'_{weak} by the uniform H-bound, and equicontinuous as a family of V'-valued functions, the Arzelà–Ascoli theorem implies that $(u_n)_n$ is relatively compact in $C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}})$. This means that every sequence admits a subsequence that converges in $C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}})$. Hence there exists a subsequence $(u_{n_k})_k$ and some limit u such that

$$u_{n_k} \to u \qquad \text{in } C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}}).$$

To prove strong convergence in $L^2([0,T];H)$, we apply the interpolation fact to the difference $u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)$, square the inequality, and integrate over time:

$$\int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_H^2 \, dt \le \varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt + C_\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_{V'}^2 \, dt.$$

We now analyze the two terms on the right-hand side.

For the V-term, we do not have strong convergence in V. However, recall that we already proved the uniform a priori bound

$$\sup_{n\ge 1} \int_0^T \|u_n(t)\|_V^2 \, dt < \infty.$$

Using

$$\|a-b\|_V^2 \le 2\|a\|_V^2 + 2\|b\|_V^2,$$

we obtain

$$\int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt \le 2\int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t)\|_V^2 \, dt + 2\int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt.$$

Hence

$$\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt \le 2\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t)\|_V^2 \, dt + 2\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt.$$

Since $(u_{n_k})_k$ inherits the uniform $L^2([0,T];V)$ bound from $(u_n)_n$, and since $u \in L^2([0,T];V)$, there exists a constant $C < \infty$ such that

$$\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt \le C\varepsilon.$$

For the V'-term, the convergence in the dual space implies that

$$\int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_{V'}^2 \, dt \to 0 \qquad \text{as } k \to \infty.$$

Therefore, taking $\limsup_{k\to\infty}$ in

$$\int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_H^2 \, dt \le \varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt + C_\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_{V'}^2 \, dt,$$

we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\limsup_{k\to\infty} \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_H^2 \, dt &\le \limsup_{k\to\infty} \varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_V^2 \, dt \\ &\quad + \limsup_{k\to\infty} C_\varepsilon \int_0^T \|u_{n_k}(t) - u(t)\|_{V'}^2 \, dt \\ &\le C\varepsilon.\end{aligned}$$

Since $\varepsilon > 0$ is arbitrary, it follows that

$$u_{n_k} \to u \qquad \text{strongly in } L^2([0,T];H).$$

Thus we have extracted a strongly convergent subsequence. This is exactly the compactness needed for τ_3-tightness, and Lemma 3.14 is complete. □

Appendix: Functional-Analytic Side Note

As a brief functional-analytic side note, if (μ_n) is a tight sequence of probability measures on U, then Prokhorov's theorem yields a subsequence (μ_{n_k}) that converges weakly to some limit measure μ.

What does weak convergence mean? It means that for every bounded continuous test function $\ell \in C_b(U)$,

$$\int_U \ell \, d\mu_{n_k} \to \int_U \ell \, d\mu.$$

If $\ell \in C_b(U)$ is any bounded continuous test function, then along this subsequence one has

$$\Phi(\ell) := \lim_{k\to\infty} \int_U \ell \, d\mu_{n_k} \qquad \text{for all } \ell \in C_b(U).$$

This defines a linear functional Φ on $C_b(U)$, and it is positive because $\ell \geq 0$ implies

$$\int_U \ell \, d\mu_{n_k} \geq 0.$$

Theorem 1 (Riesz–Markov–Kakutani representation theorem)**.** Let U be a suitable topological space and let Φ be a positive linear functional on a space of continuous test functions on U. Then there exists a unique finite Borel measure μ on U such that

$$\Phi(\ell) = \int_U \ell \, d\mu \qquad \text{for all admissible test functions } \ell.$$

By this Riesz–Markov–Kakutani representation theorem, there exists a probability measure μ on U such that

$$\Phi(\ell) = \int_U \ell \, d\mu \qquad \text{for all } \ell \in C_b(U).$$

This measure μ is exactly the weak limit measure. This is the essence of Prokhorov's theorem in the present setting.

Appendix: Arzelà–Ascoli

Theorem 2 (Arzelà–Ascoli theorem)**.** Let K be a compact metric space, let E be a metric space, and let $C(K;E)$ denote the space of continuous functions from K into E. Let $\mathcal{F} \subset C(K;E)$. If

- for every $t \in K$, the set $\{f(t) : f \in \mathcal{F}\}$ is relatively compact in E;
- $\mathcal{F}$ is equicontinuous,

then $\mathcal{F}$ is relatively compact in $C(K;E)$ for the uniform topology.

Informally, a family of continuous functions $\mathcal{F}$ is precompact in the uniform norm if it is pointwise precompact and uniformly equicontinuous.

In Section 5.1, we apply this with $K = [0,T]$ and $E = V'_{\text{weak}}$. The H-bound together with Banach–Alaoglu gives the required pointwise relative compactness, while the Hölder estimate gives equicontinuity.

Appendix: Equicontinuity of V'-Valued Functions

Definition 1 (Equicontinuity of V'-valued functions)**.** Let $(u_n)_n$ be a family of functions from $[0,T]$ into V'. We say that $(u_n)_n$ is equicontinuous as a family of V'-valued functions if the family of paths

$$u_n : [0,T] \to V'$$

is equicontinuous uniformly in n. Formally, for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that whenever $|t-s| < \delta$,

$$\|u_n(t) - u_n(s)\|_{V'} < \varepsilon \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

In other words, the same δ works for every function u_n, not just for one fixed n.

A uniform Hölder estimate of the form

$$\|u_n(t) - u_n(s)\|_{V'} \le C|t-s|^{\beta} \qquad \text{for all } n$$

immediately implies equicontinuity.

Appendix: Kolmogorov Continuity Theorem

Theorem 3 (Kolmogorov continuity theorem)**.** Let $(X_t)_{t\in[0,T]}$ be a stochastic process with values in a Banach space E. Suppose there exist constants $p \ge 1$, $\beta > 0$, and $C > 0$ such that

$$\mathbb{E}\big[\|X_t - X_s\|_E^p\big] \le C|t-s|^{1+\beta} \qquad \text{for all } s,t \in [0,T].$$

Then X admits a modification whose sample paths are Hölder continuous of every order

$$\alpha < \frac{\beta}{p}.$$

Informally, if the moments of the increments decay sufficiently fast as $|t-s| \to 0$, then the sample paths cannot oscillate too wildly and therefore admit a Hölder-continuous modification. More concretely, for one sample path $t \mapsto X_t(\omega)$, this means there is quantitative control of the form

$$\|X_t(\omega) - X_s(\omega)\|_E \le C(\omega)\,|t-s|^{\alpha}$$

for nearby times s,t. Thus, when t is close to s, the value of the path cannot change too much.

In Section 5.4, we apply this to the scalar-valued stochastic integral after deriving a moment estimate of the form

$$\mathbb{E}\big[|X_t - X_s|^p\big] \le C|t-s|^{1+\beta}.$$

This yields time Hölder continuity for every exponent $\alpha < \beta/p$.

Appendix: Meaning of the Three Topologies

In this context, a topology tells us what it means for a sequence of paths to converge, and therefore what the compact sets are when we speak about tightness. Since Lemma 3.14 is stated on the intersection space

$$\Omega := C([0,T]; V'_{\text{weak}}) \cap L^2([0,T]; V) \cap L^2([0,T]; H),$$

we must specify the topology in each component.

A.1. The Weak Topology τ_1

The topology τ_1 is the weak topology on $L^2([0,T];V)$. A sequence u_n converges to u in this topology if

$$u_n \rightharpoonup u \qquad \text{in } L^2([0,T];V),$$

that is, if for every continuous linear functional Λ on $L^2([0,T];V)$ one has

$$\Lambda(u_n) \to \Lambda(u).$$

Equivalently, using the Hilbert space pairing, this means that for every $v \in L^2([0,T];V)$,

$$\int_0^T \langle u_n(t), v(t)\rangle_V \, dt \to \int_0^T \langle u(t), v(t)\rangle_V \, dt.$$

Thus weak convergence is convergence only after testing against all linear functionals; it is weaker than norm convergence.

A.2. The Uniform Topology τ_2

The topology τ_2 is the uniform topology on $C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}})$. Here the paths take values in V', but V' is equipped with its weak topology. A sequence u_n converges to u in this topology if for every $v \in V$,

$$\sup_{t\in[0,T]} |{}_{V'}\langle u_n(t) - u(t), v\rangle_V| \to 0.$$

So one first tests the path against a fixed vector $v \in V$, obtaining a scalar-valued function of time, and then requires uniform convergence in time of those scalar functions.

A.3. The Strong Topology τ_3

The topology τ_3 is the strong topology on $L^2([0,T];H)$, namely the usual norm topology. A sequence u_n converges to u in this topology if

$$\|u_n - u\|_{L^2([0,T];H)} \to 0,$$

equivalently,

$$\int_0^T \|u_n(t) - u(t)\|_H^2 \, dt \to 0.$$

This is stronger than weak convergence because it controls the full $L^2([0,T];H)$ norm of the difference.

A.4. Open Neighborhoods in the Three Topologies

A topology is a choice of open sets on a space. Equivalently, one may describe it by specifying a family of basic open neighborhoods around each point. In the present setting, the three topologies can be described as follows.

The weak topology has fewer open sets than the strong topology, so it is coarser. The strong topology has more open sets, so it is finer. This is exactly why strong convergence implies weak convergence, but not conversely.

For the strong topology τ_3 on $L^2([0,T];H)$, a basic open neighborhood of u is the norm ball

$$B_\varepsilon^{\text{strong}}(u) := \left\{ v \in L^2([0,T];H) : \|v - u\|_{L^2([0,T];H)} < \varepsilon \right\}.$$

For the weak topology τ_1 on $L^2([0,T];V)$, a basic open neighborhood of u is

$$U(u;\Lambda_1,\dots,\Lambda_m,\varepsilon) := \left\{ v \in L^2([0,T];V) : |\Lambda_j(v-u)| < \varepsilon, \quad j=1,\dots,m \right\},$$

where $\Lambda_1,\dots,\Lambda_m$ are continuous linear functionals on $L^2([0,T];V)$. Equivalently, one may write

$$U(u;g_1,\dots,g_m,\varepsilon) := \left\{ v : \left| \int_0^T \langle v(t)-u(t), g_j(t)\rangle_V \, dt \right| < \varepsilon, \quad j=1,\dots,m \right\},$$

with $g_1,\dots,g_m \in L^2([0,T];V)$.

For the uniform topology τ_2 on $C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}})$, a basic open neighborhood of u is

$$U(u;v_1,\dots,v_m,\varepsilon) := \left\{ w \in C([0,T];V'_{\text{weak}}) : \sup_{t\in[0,T]} |{}_{V'}\langle w(t)-u(t), v_j\rangle_V| < \varepsilon, \quad j=1,\dots,m \right\},$$

where $v_1,\dots,v_m \in V$.

A.5. Why the Topologies Matter

Tightness is a statement about compact sets, and compactness depends on the topology. This is why Lemma 3.14 must specify τ_1,τ_2,τ_3 explicitly:

- τ_1 is used because the a priori estimate gives weak compactness in $L^2([0,T];V)$;
- τ_2 is used to control continuity of the trajectories in the dual space;
- τ_3 is the crucial strong topology on $L^2([0,T];H)$, where the compact embedding $V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H$ gives the extra compactness needed in the argument.

A.5a. Compact Embedding

Definition 2 (Compact embedding)**.** Let X and Y be Banach spaces with a continuous embedding $X \hookrightarrow Y$. We say that the embedding

$$X \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow Y$$

is compact if every bounded sequence in X admits a subsequence that converges strongly in Y.

In particular, if

$$V \hookrightarrow\hookrightarrow H,$$

then every bounded sequence in V has a subsequence converging strongly in H.

A.5b. Continuous Embedding and Strong Convergence

Definition 3 (Continuous embedding)**.** Let X and Y be Banach spaces. We say that

$$X \hookrightarrow Y$$

continuously if there exists a constant $C > 0$ such that

$$\|x\|_Y \le C\|x\|_X \qquad \text{for all } x \in X.$$

In this case, strong convergence in the stronger space X implies strong convergence in the weaker space Y. Indeed, if

$$x_n \to x \qquad \text{strongly in } X,$$

then

$$\|x_n - x\|_Y \le C\|x_n - x\|_X \to 0,$$

and therefore

$$x_n \to x \qquad \text{strongly in } Y.$$

A.5c. Hausdorff Spaces and Uniqueness of Limits

Definition 4 (Hausdorff space)**.** A topological space X is called Hausdorff if for every pair of distinct points $x \neq y$ in X, there exist open sets $U, V \subset X$ such that

$$x \in U, \qquad y \in V, \qquad U \cap V = \varnothing.$$

In a Hausdorff space, limits are unique. In particular, all normed spaces and Banach spaces are Hausdorff, so a sequence cannot converge to two different limits in the same topology.

A.5d. Why One Uses $\limsup$

Suppose $(a_k)_k$, $(b_k)_k$, and $(c_k)_k$ are real sequences such that

$$a_k \le \varepsilon b_k + c_k \qquad \text{for all } k,$$

where $(b_k)_k$ is uniformly bounded and $c_k \to 0$. In this situation one should pass to the limit superior:

$$\limsup_{k\to\infty} a_k \le \varepsilon \limsup_{k\to\infty} b_k + \limsup_{k\to\infty} c_k.$$

Since $(b_k)_k$ is bounded, $\limsup_{k\to\infty} b_k < \infty$, and since $c_k \to 0$, one obtains

$$\limsup_{k\to\infty} a_k \le C\varepsilon$$

for some finite constant C.

The reason for using $\limsup$ instead of an ordinary limit is that the estimate does not by itself show that $(a_k)_k$ has a limit. A bounded sequence may oscillate, so one can control its asymptotic upper bound without yet knowing convergence. If in addition $a_k \ge 0$ and

$$\limsup_{k\to\infty} a_k \le C\varepsilon \qquad \text{for every } \varepsilon > 0,$$

then

$$\limsup_{k\to\infty} a_k \le 0.$$

Because also $a_k \ge 0$, this forces

$$a_k \to 0.$$

A.6. Hölder Inequality and $1/2$-Hölder Continuity

The time-regularity estimate for the drift term comes from the elementary inequality

$$\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V \, dr \le |t-s|^{1/2} \Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2},$$

which is just Hölder's inequality in time, or equivalently Cauchy–Schwarz. Because the right-hand side contains the factor $|t-s|^{1/2}$, this shows that the drift increment has $1/2$-Hölder continuity in time, up to the energy term $\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr$.

A.6a. Proof of the Drift Hölder-Seminorm Estimate

Let

$$D(t) := \int_0^t A(u(r)) \, dr.$$

We claim that for every $\beta \in (0, 1/2]$,

$$[D]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} \le M \Big(T^{1-\beta} + T^{1/2-\beta} \Big(\int_0^T \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2} \Big).$$

Indeed, for $0 \le s < t \le T$, the growth condition on A gives

$$\begin{aligned}
\|D(t) - D(s)\|_{V'} &= \Big\| \int_s^t A(u(r)) \, dr \Big\|_{V'} \\
&\le \int_s^t \|A(u(r))\|_{V'} \, dr && \text{(triangle inequality for the integral)} \\
&\le M \int_s^t (1 + \|u(r)\|_V) \, dr && \text{(by (V.3))} \\
&\le M \Big(|t-s| + |t-s|^{1/2} \Big(\int_s^t \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2} \Big) && \text{(since } \int_s^t 1 \, dr = |t-s| \text{ and by Hölder/Cauchy–S} \\
&\le M \Big(|t-s| + |t-s|^{1/2} \Big(\int_0^T \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2} \Big) && \text{(since } [s,t] \subset [0,T]).
\end{aligned}$$

Dividing by $|t-s|^\beta$ and using $|t-s| \le T$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\|D(t) - D(s)\|_{V'}}{|t-s|^\beta} &\le M \Big(|t-s|^{1-\beta} + |t-s|^{1/2-\beta} \Big(\int_0^T \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2} \Big) && \text{(dividing by } |t-s|^\beta) \\
&\le M \Big(T^{1-\beta} + T^{1/2-\beta} \Big(\int_0^T \|u(r)\|_V^2 \, dr \Big)^{1/2} \Big) && \text{(since } |t-s| \le T \text{ and } \beta \le 1/2).
\end{aligned}$$

Taking the supremum over $0 \le s < t \le T$ proves the claim.

A.7. Burkholder–Davis–Gundy Inequality

Let M_t be a continuous local martingale and let $p \ge 1$. Then there exists a constant $C_p > 0$ such that

$$\mathbb{E}\Big(\sup_{r \in [s,t]} |M_r - M_s|^p \Big) \le C_p \, \mathbb{E}\big(\langle M \rangle_t - \langle M \rangle_s \big)^{p/2}.$$

In Section 5.4, this is applied to the stochastic integral

$$M_r := \int_s^r \langle h, B_n(u(\rho))\, dW_n(\rho)\rangle,$$

so that the supremum of the stochastic increment is controlled by the corresponding quadratic variation.

A.8. How Aubin–Lions Yields τ_3-Tightness

We now explain how the Aubin–Lions compactness statement gives the actual tightness for the strong topology τ_3 on $L^2([0,T];H)$.

Fix $R \geq 1$ and define

$$K_3(R) := \left\{ u : \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2\, dt \leq R,\ \sup_{0\leq t\leq T} \|u(t)\|_H \leq R,\ [u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} \leq R \right\},$$

where

$$[u]_{C^\beta([0,T];V')} := \sup_{0\leq s<t\leq T} \frac{\|u(t)-u(s)\|_{V'}}{|t-s|^\beta}.$$

Recall that the Aubin–Lions lemma says that a family bounded in $L^2([0,T];V)\cap L^\infty([0,T];H)$ and equicontinuous as a family of V'-valued functions is relatively compact in $L^2([0,T];H)$. On $K_3(R)$, these hypotheses are satisfied by definition. Hence, by Aubin–Lions, $K_3(R)$ is relatively compact in $L^2([0,T];H)$.

Next, note that

$$K_3(R)^c \subset \left\{ u : \int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2\, dt > R \right\} \cup K_2(R)^c,$$

where $K_2(R)$ is the compact set used in the proof of τ_2-tightness. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} P_n\big(K_3(R)^c\big) &\leq P_n\Big(\int_0^T \|u(t)\|_V^2\, dt > R\Big) + P_n\big(K_2(R)^c\big) \\ &\leq \frac{C}{R} + \frac{C}{R} \qquad \text{(by the estimates for } \tau_1 \text{ and } \tau_2) \\ &\leq \frac{C}{R}. \end{aligned}$$

We conclude that

$$\sup_n P_n\big(K_3(R)^c\big) \leq \frac{C}{R} \to 0 \qquad \text{as } R\to\infty.$$

Thus the sequence $(P_n)_n$ is tight in the strong topology τ_3 on $L^2([0,T];H)$.